Basil Mozzarella Pasta

DAIRY

Prep **15 min** Cook **25 min** Total **40 min** Serves **4**



Ingredients

- **1/4 cup** olive oil
- **1 16-ounce package** mozzarella — cubed
- **4 cloves** garlic — Minced
- **1 cup** basil leaves — chopped (reserve a few leaves for garnish)
- crushed dried red pepper — to taste
- salt and pepper — to taste
- **1 28-ounce can** crushed San Marzano tomatoes
- **1 lb** fusilli or other corkscrew pasta

Instructions

1. Combine the olive oil, garlic, basil, crushed red pepper, salt and pepper, and crushed tomatoes in a deep pan, stirring together, and simmer for 15 minutes
2. Add cubed mozzarella, depends how melted you want it for the time
3. Boil the pasta as directed. Drain, then pour the hot pasta over the sauce. Mix and serve.

Yidi's version: uses a can of crushed tomatoes instead of whole tomatoes, so there is no crushing or simmering the tomatoes first. Everything is mixed cold, then warmed in a pot until the mozzarella melts. Adapted from Christina Conti's Pasta Caprese (newspaper clipping). — Newspaper clipping: Christina Conti's Pasta Caprese